🛠 CHEAT SHEET

AI Tools Worth Trying

A curated list of free AI tools organized by what you actually want to do

Congratulations on completing Module 3. You earned this.

1 Writing & Editing

Tools that help you write better, faster, and with less effort.

ChatGPT
chat.openai.com

Writes, edits, summarizes, and answers questions in plain English.

Free: **GPT-4o mini unlimited; GPT-4o daily limits**

Best for: **Drafting emails, rewriting awkward text, brainstorming**

Claude
claude.ai

Conversational AI that's especially good at long documents and nuanced writing.

Free: **Limited daily messages on Claude Sonnet**

Best for: **Summarizing long articles, writing that needs careful tone**

Grammarly
grammarly.com

Checks grammar, spelling, tone, and clarity as you type — anywhere on the web.

Free: **Core grammar & spelling; tone detection in browser extension**

Best for: **Proofreading emails and assignments before you hit send**

QuillBot
quillbot.com

Paraphrases, summarizes, and rewrites sentences in different styles.

Free: **Paraphraser (125 words), summarizer (1,200 words), grammar check**

Best for: **Rewriting for clarity, summarizing an article fast**

Hemingway Editor
hemingwayapp.com

Highlights sentences that are too long, passive voice, and hard-to-read phrases.

Free: **Full editing in browser — no account required**

Best for: **Making your writing easier to read for any audience**

2 Image Creation

Turn a text description into a real image — no design skills needed.

Adobe Firefly

firefly.adobe.com

Generates images from text descriptions using Adobe's AI.

Free: **25 generative credits per month; no subscription required**

Best for: **Clean, professional-looking images without design skills**

Microsoft Designer

designer.microsoft.com

Generates images from text using DALL-E; also makes social media graphics.

Free: **Generous daily boosts; free with a Microsoft account**

Best for: **Quick social posts, greeting cards, or visual ideas — fast and easy**

Canva AI

canva.com

Generates images and designs from text inside Canva's full design tool.

Free: **Limited AI image credits per month on the free plan**

Best for: **Designing AND generating images in one place**

Google ImageFX

aitestkitchen.withgoogle.com

Generates high-quality images from text prompts using Google's AI.

Free: **Free with a Google account**

Best for: **Experimenting with creative image ideas — very accessible interface**

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3 Research & Learning

Find information faster and actually understand what you're reading.

Perplexity AI

perplexity.ai

Answers questions like a search engine but with cited, summarized responses.

Free: **Unlimited standard searches; limited Pro searches per day**

Best for: **Researching topics and seeing where the information comes from**

Google NotebookLM

notebooklm.google.com

Lets you upload your own documents and then ask questions about them.

Free: **Fully free with Google account; up to 50 sources per notebook**

Best for: **Studying a book, understanding a long report, reviewing meeting notes**

Consensus

consensus.app

Searches academic research papers and summarizes what the science actually says.

Free: **Limited searches per day; enough for most everyday questions**

Best for: **Fact-checking health claims, understanding research without full papers**

Explainpaper

explainpaper.com

Upload a research paper and ask it to explain confusing parts in plain English.

Free: **Basic explanations are free**

Best for: **Understanding a study without a science background**

4 Productivity & Organization

Work smarter. Let AI handle the scheduling, note-taking, and follow-through.

Notion AI

notion.so

Adds AI writing, summarizing, and task assistance inside Notion's workspace.

Free: **Notion itself is free; AI features have a limited free trial**

Best for: **Notion users who want AI to help draft or summarize notes**

Reclaim.ai

reclaim.ai

Automatically schedules your tasks, habits, and focus time around your calendar.

Free: **1 calendar, basic task scheduling, and habit tracking**

Best for: **Anyone who struggles to find time between meetings**

Otter.ai

otter.ai

Records meetings and conversations and turns them into searchable transcripts.

Free: **300 minutes of transcription per month; up to 3 audio imports**

Best for: **Taking notes in meetings or lectures without missing anything**

Mem

mem.ai

AI-powered note-taking that automatically connects related notes over time.

Free: **Basic notes are free; AI features require paid plan**

Best for: **Heavy note-takers who want AI to surface connections**

5 Video & Audio

Transcribe, edit, and create audio and video without the headache.

ElevenLabs

elevenlabs.io

Converts text into realistic spoken audio in many voices and languages.

Free: **10,000 characters per month (~10 minutes of audio)**

Best for: **Voiceovers, listening to articles read aloud, accessibility**

Descript

Edit audio and video by editing the transcript — like editing a document.

descript.com

Free: **Up to 1 hour of transcription per month; watermark-free basic exports**

Best for: **Podcasters and video creators who want to cut filler words fast**

CapCut

capcut.com

Video editing with AI features including auto-captions, background removal, and effects.

Free: **Very generous — most features free; no watermark on most exports**

Best for: **Short-form social media video editing — no experience needed**

6 Presentations & Documents

Go from blank page to polished presentation in minutes.

Gamma

gamma.app

Creates polished presentations, documents, and web pages from a text prompt.

Free: **400 AI credits on signup — enough for several full presentations**

Best for: **Building a presentation from scratch in minutes**

Beautiful.ai

beautiful.ai

Smart slides that automatically adjust layout and design as you add content.

Free: **Unlimited presentations with Beautiful.ai branding; basic templates**

Best for: **Professional-looking slides without design work**

ChatPDF

chatpdf.com

Upload any PDF and ask it questions in plain English.

Free: **2 PDFs per day, up to 120 pages each; 50 questions per PDF**

Best for: **Understanding contracts, summarizing manuals, reviewing reports**

Slides AI

slidesai.io

Turns text or a topic into a full Google Slides presentation automatically.

Free: **3 presentations per month**

Best for: **Google Slides users who want AI to do the first draft**

7 Coding & Technical

You don't need to be a developer to use these — they're great for beginners too.

GitHub Copilot

github.com/features/copilot

Suggests code as you type, explains code in plain English, and fixes errors.

Free: **Free for individuals — 2,000 code completions/month on free plan**

Best for: **Beginners who want help understanding what they're typing**

Replit AI

replit.com

Browser-based coding environment with AI that helps you write and debug code.

Free: **Free account with limited compute; AI features on free tier**

Best for: **Trying coding without installing anything on your computer**

Claude

claude.ai

Explains code, helps debug, and walks beginners through technical concepts.

Free: **Limited daily messages on the free plan**

Best for: **Asking "what does this code do?" or "how do I fix this error?"**

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8 Fun & Creative

Just because it's AI doesn't mean it has to be serious. These are genuinely fun.

Suno

suno.com

Generates full songs — lyrics, melody, instruments, vocals — from a text prompt.

Free: **50 credits per day (~10 songs); non-commercial use on free plan**

Best for: **Creating birthday songs, experimenting with music, or just having fun**

Character.ai

character.ai

Chat with AI versions of fictional characters, historical figures, or custom personas.

Free: **Fully free with an account; some wait times during peak hours**

Best for: **Creative writing, practicing conversations, entertainment**

Nightcafe

nightcafe.studio

Generates art in different artistic styles from text descriptions.

Free: **5 free credits per day; earn more by participating in the community**

Best for: **Exploring art styles — impressionist, oil painting, digital art, and more**

A few things to keep in mind

- **Free tiers change.** Companies adjust what they offer for free all the time. If something listed as free now costs money, that's normal — check the tool's website.
- **Your data matters.** Most free tools use your inputs to improve their models. Avoid typing sensitive personal information (passwords, financial details, private medical info) into any AI tool.
- **AI makes mistakes.** Every tool on this list will occasionally be wrong. Always double-check anything important.

→ **You don't need to try them all.** Pick one or two that match something you actually do. That's enough to get started.

"Tools change fast. What matters is knowing where to start."